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FOR YOU

as an FAE or a technical sales and solutions consultant, your skills horizon immediately expands," says a senior application engineer at Altair Engineering.

Prerequisites for the job

With field application engineering now recognised globally as a white-collared job, it is vital that you possess below-mentioned technical skills along with general ones:

1. As stated above, the primary requirement to work as an FAE (often referred to as technical sales engineer) is an engineering degree, irrespective of the discipline. However, elementary technical skills are a must-have. Some companies even seek a master's degree in VLSI or embedded systems.

2. As per job listings on Naukri.com, the common skillsets for field application engineers include (but not limited to) System Verilog, technical support skills, VLSI, embedded systems, HDL, C, product designing (both hardware and software), software testing and technical sales.

3. Effective communication skills. In addition, there are skills depending on the sector and the company you choose to work in.

Career progression and pay packages

Experts opine that a career in field application engineering or technical sales is not suited for fancy job title seekers, but rather those looking at utilising their technical talent in sales.

To start with, fresh engineers are hired as trainees or offered designations such as application engineer, field application engineer and technical sales executive. There is a possibility that you could be offered business-oriented job titles like project manager and account manager based on your experience level.

"With experience, you improve your business skills as you work with clients closely. There are many

opportunities to travel in this job as you may need to meet clients or manufacturers personally," shares Utsava.

Making the right decisions throughout the course of your career could fast-track your progression and even lead you to the CEO level. Business qualities and talent are the deciding factors in such scenarios. The more positive business that you generate, the faster your career progression.

As far as pay packages are concerned, fresh engineers can expect pay packages starting at around ₹ 240,000 per annum. This again depends on your area of expertise, job requirements, work profile and the company's reputation. Experienced candidates can expect anywhere between one and two million rupees per annum.

"With new products and technologies popping up in the market every other day, the demand for field application engineers is increasing and there is a good scope for engineers to start their career in this field. Apart from attractive compensation, the job comes with advantages of learning business, travelling, meeting lots of people, continuous learning, challenging professional environment and a lot more," says Utsava.

The applications engineer at Altair Engineering advises FAEs to remain optimistic about their remuneration. In case they stick to one company over an extended period of time, their pay package would be directly proportional to the amount of effort put in.

It is a level-playing field

Unlike core information technology enabled services, field application engineering domain is less competitive. However, your interview would still be challenging as you will play a critical role in the success of your prospective employer organisation with the combination of your technical and sales skills. **EFY**